

RIGHTVISION NEWSWIRE

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FINANCIAL MARKETS**

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September 16th 2026



No Major Economic Events Today

Federal fund rate at 11:00 pm

FOMC press conf at 11:30 pm

Did You Know?

the dollar was hanging on to recent gains on Wednesday and trading near multi-week highs on a handful of major peers ahead of a Federal Reserve decision where traders expect the first of what could be several U.S. interest rate hikes. Currency markets haven't really moved that much while global bond yields have been climbing in concert over recent weeks because sovereign bonds have moved in tandem and not shifted relative differences between countries' yields very far.

But the dollar's gained traction in the last few sessions on thinking that despite Warsh being hired by President Donald Trump to cut interest rates, he'll need to hike a few times to show the Fed is serious about taming inflation that is being fanned by war with Iran and the resulting energy price surge.



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Gold



Gold prices edged lower on Wednesday as elevated oil prices and a renewed rise in Treasury yields kept pressure on bullion ahead of the Federal Reserve's policy decision later in the day.

Markets are pricing a roughly 92% chance of a rate hike, while investors also weigh the risk that stubborn inflation could keep longer-term borrowing costs elevated.

Gold has fallen for two sessions and is now down more than 3% in September, after trading above \$4,700 an ounce in late August as traders repeatedly recalibrated the outlook for monetary policy.

The latest pressure comes as high oil prices continue to reinforce inflation concerns. Oil steadied after rising for two straight sessions, while uncertainty over the duration of Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline shutdown kept energy markets on edge.

Inside The News

Oil prices fell on Wednesday as data pointing to an unexpected build in U.S. inventories overshadowed continued supply disruptions in the Middle East after Saudi Arabia halted loadings at a major port due to Houthi attacks.

Crude was also subject to some profit-taking after appreciating sharply in recent weeks on worsening Houthi-Saudi hostilities and a continued standoff in the Strait of Hormuz.

Brent oil futures fell 0.75% to \$107.94 a barrel by 00:04 ET (04:04 GMT), while West Texas Intermediate crude futures fell 1.1% to \$104.70 a barrel.

But bigger losses in crude were limited, as risk premium from dwindling Middle East supplies kept prices close to annual highs. Traders were wary of any big bets ahead of a closely watched Federal Reserve meeting later in the day, where the central bank is widely expected to hike interest rates.

Data from the American Petroleum Institute showed U.S. inventories unexpectedly grew 7.14 million barrels in the week to September 11, more than expectations for a 1.8 mb draw.

The print usually heralds a similar reading from official inventory data, which is due later on Wednesday.

But the API data indicated that despite global supply disruptions, stockpiles in the world's largest fuel consumer remained steady. Still, the build could also stem from continued releases from the U.S. Strategic Petroleum Reserve. Data from the Energy Information Administration showed the SPR shrank by nearly 130 mb so far in 2026, to 285.36 million barrels.

Crude Oil



Currencies



Asian currencies were mostly subdued on Wednesday, with the Japanese yen weakening to a one-week low as the U.S. dollar held near multi-week highs ahead of the Federal Reserve's policy decision and a Bank of Japan meeting later this week.

The US Dollar Index was around 99.63, little changed, after rising alongside Treasury yields in recent sessions. The USD/JPY pair rose 0.2%, taking the yen further away from its recent seven-month high of 152.89.

The kiwi was among the weaker currencies, with NZD/USD down 0.7% to \$0.5742, while the EUR/USD pair and the GBP/USD pair were little changed. The Australian dollar was around \$0.7128.

The dollar has gained more traction in recent sessions as markets increasingly expect the Federal Reserve to resume raising rates. Traders are looking for the first hike in a potential series of increases, with inflation pressures being reinforced by the surge in energy prices linked to the Middle East conflict.

Inside The News

U.S. stock index futures rose slightly on Tuesday evening with markets turning largely cautious before a widely expected interest rate hike by the Federal Reserve.

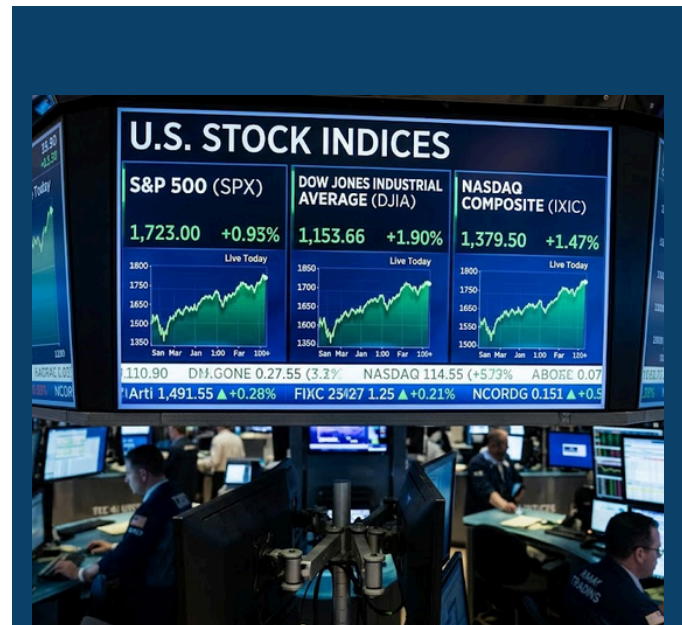
High oil prices, amid continued military tensions in the Middle East, also kept markets on edge, as did surging Treasury yields.

S&P 500 Futures rose 0.1% to 7,663.50 points by 19:25 ET (23:25 GMT). Nasdaq 100 Futures rose 0.1% to 29,274.0 points, and Dow Jones Futures rose 0.1% to 52,574.0 points.

Futures rose after two straight days of losses on Wall Street, as rising oil prices, a rout in artificial intelligence stocks, and anticipation of a Fed rate hike on Wednesday spurred selling in risk-driven markets.

The Fed is widely expected to raise interest rates by at least 25 basis points to 4.0% at the conclusion of its two-day meeting on Wednesday.

Bets on a hike were fueled by several policymakers voicing concern over increasingly sticky inflation, with data for August, released last week, also highlighting elevated price pressures.



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